

Private Worship Vol IV - 5

Worship Sets Good Things in Motion and Draws Opposition

I was thinking I knew how to worship, and then I stumbled across the verse on approaching God and thought, "Uh-oh, I do not know as much as I think I do."

But I know this: you cannot raise those hands, have faith, glorify Him, and turn your heart loose without starting to order good things in your life. Just because you are ordering the good things does not mean the devil is going to look at it and decide he needs to cancel that order. Here he comes to cancel the good things ordered for you, and the war is on.

We wonder, "Why is God treating me this way?" While you are trying to figure it out, ask this: is God the One being stopped, or the One trying to bless me?

Remember, God is always the good guy. He is always doing what is best for you. The devil is always the one intervening, trying to do the worst. But this I do know: you cannot lift your hands, glorify, magnify, and exalt Him without setting things into motion. There is movement in the spiritual world. The wind starts blowing. Things start happening.

You cannot hang around truth without, after a while, starting to act like you believe it. You cannot hang around truth without it affecting you.

I am looking forward to the months to come. I am so excited inside I can hardly stand it. Just to know I have already won:

Greater is He that is in you than he that is in the world.

Behold, I give you power over all the power of the enemy.

When the circumstances come flooding in, that is what you say. "God, You are pouring out the good. Devil, you are pouring out the bad. I do not care at what place I stop him, just so he gets stopped. I do not care what kind of school God puts me through, just so I graduate with an A."

You get excited when you find out you are smarter than you thought you were. How can that be? Because you are in here worshipping God. You are smarter than you thought you were.

What are you doing now? Having a good time. A real good time.

Praise Under Pressure Becomes the Party of Faith

How many of you throw parties and have great victorious times of fellowshiping with God when everything looks like it is not going to make it? It is easy to have the other ones. Do you know when God loves it? When you cannot go that way, cannot go that way, cannot go backward, and do

not want to go down. You do not want to go up yet either.

"Woe is me. What is left? I am beyond bankruptcy. They are suing the people for the money they are suing me for."

Party time.

When you are giving Him what He needs, what in this world can overpower you? This is a good sign that you believe Him.

"My feelings do not feel like doing that."

Who runs your ship?

Victory and winning are fine, but if you cannot pick up a shovel and shovel for minimum wage so you can feed yourself, then you have to fight to win somewhere else, not with the shovel.

How many believe that when Jesus died, He left something out? How do you know? "Because I have been praying, and He is not doing anything." He did not miss anything.

You know when fellowship can be richest? I can speak firsthand on some of these things now. I testified here, and I was shocked to hear myself say what I was saying because I really did not think I was doing too badly. I had cut myself off from things. I did not think I was doing badly.

What I did not know is that I was surviving partially.

For the longest time I did not mention Bill, Steve, even David Hartley. I took all of that and put it over here, and then I lived over here. But I had brothers, sisters, and relatives out there who loved me. Years could go by without calling one of them, checking in, or being in the same city.

How could you go years knowing somebody, not check in, and still be pastoring? Because I knew He called me a long time before that part began: revival in Tulsa. Not necessarily a church per se, though a church, but revival.

When these things started happening, I think somehow it pushed me forward up against the wall, and there was nowhere to go except beyond any love I had known or any hurt. I did. The best way I can describe it is that an avalanche fell behind me and the past could not get through it. I cannot get through it either, as if I would want to.

Immediately, if I am able to talk, things began to change. In the other place He took me as far as He could take me in the love of God, I think. But when the avalanche fell behind me and closed off everything, it seemed like in the spirit I stepped over a line where it actively started killing the things that had worked on me for so many years.

When I cleared it, I noticed the absence of something. It grew stronger and stronger until I knew what it was. I started talking about it and could not shut up.

Praying in Tongues Preserved the Foundation for Revival

I think the thing that salvaged the devil's plan is the place I had prayed myself to in the Holy Ghost. This is what I love about praying in the Holy Ghost so much. It can be emotionless or emotional, because what you add to it does not put strength to what you are praying, since you do not even know what it is. That is why He leaves you out, so He can answer it.

Praying in tongues cannot give me what fasting does, but praying in tongues gives me the understanding of fasting, then puts the key in my hand and says, "Unlock that door now and do it." Then fasting gives me what praying in tongues cannot.

Obviously the praying in tongues, which we are stubborn about around here, put something in place. God knows the very depth of your heart, your problem, your call, and your life. Then He comes and creates this prayer in your spirit so the authority switches over to you, because it is coming from you. One member of the Godhead is creating the prayer, and the others are answering it. It gets hard to fail if you follow the Book.

I had to have prayed myself there. Even when the devil was panicking and I was pressing for revival, I was on long fasts. I would come off one and go on another. Sometimes I looked like a toothpick walking around, other times like a balloon with toothpicks in it.

I got attacked hard on those fasts. How would you like to have a group of devils sing the same song to you over and over and try to tell you they are God? But that attack failed. I finished the fasting and received what I received from God. I overcame the attack of the devil on that level.

Then he quit trying to act like an angel of light and turned on me with a vicious oral attack that let me know what he was going to do to me. The first words he said against me were, "I am going to kill you."

Is that not nice? "I am going to kill you."

Why am I going over this again? Because this is what stopped revival. I am not just talking about me; we are talking history now.

I said, "If you could do that, I would already be dead."

I did not like his response. He said, "Well, I am going to kill your family then."

He moved into that area and fought. But after the avalanche, that part was cut off. I was walking out here, and I understood that the devil had a plan for me. I was supposed to have been seduced into the sensationalism move, seduced into false doctrine, defeated into giving up and quitting, or dead. I was not supposed to make it here.

When the avalanche took place, it closed it all off. I could not go back, and that could not come forward. The next step I took was into the love of God. Only this time, instead of grouping backward, it grouped forward. Everything He promised me seemed to register as absolute truth. Things lifted off me. Some things I could hardly make myself do became easy.

How do I know we are really going to have some kind of move here in Tulsa? I have known the whole time in my heart, but particularly now I know better than ever before, because what was keeping me from moving ahead in the love of God has been canceled. I know now that I can move forward and I will not be destroyed.

Look at history. We are not doing fifty-yard dashes. We are doing cross-country.

Revival History Shows Giftings Without Love Do Not Finish Well

I studied enough in history that I got some of my old books out. I love the research. God did not just record the victories these people had in revival; He recorded the other things too. I thank God that He told their weaknesses as well as their strengths.

You might leave the weaknesses out and just read about the strength. Then you look at that and say, "That is what I am going to achieve too." But you need to read about the weaknesses too.

I could go over a list. I have been in A. A. Allen's meetings. I have been in Kathryn Kuhlman's. I have been in Leroy Jenkins's. I know a lot of their history. Alexander Dowie in Chicago. I was never in William Branham's.

I would like to be in 1 Corinthians 13. How can you have so much of God? Paul said:

Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels...

He goes down the list: all faith to move mountains. But when he comes to the love of God, he says, "If I have not love, it profits me nothing."

People like William Branham saw all that was listed in 1 Corinthians 13. Alexander Dowie, with the big hat and the stairs up to his place where he sat, declared himself Elijah after bringing the city almost to its knees. What happened? How did it get in? How was the pressure not dealt with? What was lacking?

Why did God use him so powerfully and then have him bring such reproach at the end? How does God think?

William Branham, who has not heard of him? He could give you the tag number off your dog's collar, having never seen it before. He was used in a genuine gift. He would tell people what was wrong with them. If they did not believe it, sometimes he would go into such detail it was scary. Then they would finally believe and get healed. He also believed he was Elijah to come.

What do we get to thinking? That we are so special, so set apart from normal people, and that is why we are being used like this? Pretty soon the voice tells them, "You want to know something else? You are Elijah to come."

How bad is that spirit? When I was in Israel, I was at a friend's missionary outpost. They had a little church that seated about thirty people and a prophet's chamber where visiting ministers could stay. They told me that one time a man came and said, "I am Elijah to come. I heard you have a prophet's quarters."

They said, "Yes, right upstairs."

The next day another man came and said, "I am Elijah to come. I heard you have a prophet's quarters."

She said, "You can bunk with the other Elijah."

Tongues Unlocked Private Worship at the Right Time

What am I saying this for? I am making a point. I survived that. If you asked me for a key, I would say praying in tongues.

Praying in tongues kept surfacing with those mysteries I needed to know so badly. Every time I received a mystery, I would come out and preach that mystery to you, then apply it to my life and get happier. It unlocked another thing. Just at the right time, He unlocked private worship.

As far as I can see, private worship has as much to do with the love of God as any singular act I have done that has caused His love to increase in me. But the delivery of that was caused by praying in tongues.

On the way home from Oklahoma City after a passion play, I asked Him what would bring an anointing to that place. The angels flew on wires, hell was hot, everything was good, the acting was good, but the problem was there was no anointing.

I said, "What would it take to anoint this?"

He did not answer me until the way home. He said, "You would find out if you would go home and worship Me all night."

Did I? No. It was a year later, and that was because of a supernatural manifestation that took place. That happened because I did not quit doing my old friend, praying in tongues. I still needed the other key.

I was standing in a line with a few people. I do not know what they were doing or what kind of line it was. But of all people to fall out under the power, I should not have been the one. I was laying on the floor, people were bothering me, and He was saying, "When are you going to do what I told you?"

I said, "It is now."

He does not tell everybody the same thing or make everybody follow the same pattern. You have your life. You can do so much here and so much there. But I had been charged with something. I committed to worship Him between four and six hours a day, not less than four and not expected

to go over six.

Did my praying in tongues suffer a little? Only in the breakthrough time.

Dry Worship Destroyed Resistance Until Love Became Tangible

I can still remember it felt like a death sentence going into my little room, closing the door, and laying on the bed. I have a bed in there for resting, a prayer bed.

I thought, "I do not know why He is having me do this, but I cannot stop."

I started in: "I love You. Really. Hallelujah. Glory be to God." My mind would think of things to say: "Hallelujah. Glory. I worship You." Pretty soon my mind would be wandering around doing stuff, and my mouth would be saying, "Hallelujah, hallelujah," while the rest of me was somewhere else.

So I would go get myself, bring myself back, and say, "Stop it. Pay attention. Glory to God." Then my mind would wander again. I stayed in there because I am stubborn.

I cannot tell you how many flat words lay on the floor in that prayer room. It felt like a pancake factory. I was trying to get them to go up, and they went down and splattered. It went on for a period of time.

I got a few books on it, and they said, "You are just not breaking through." Thank God for praying in tongues, because that is when He gave me the mystery or vision to understand it.

In that vision, I saw heaven for a minute. There were several angels, and it looked like they were watching television, like I was the entertainment. In the vision I had my hands up. One of them commented that hell had thrown pretty much the best it had, and now it was throwing the best it had at the worship He had put me into.

Yet no matter how downcast I felt, even lost, no matter how bored I bored myself or how ugly I sounded, I had committed to a certain amount of time, and I am stubborn. That day changed. An uplift picked me up.

I did not understand what it was for a while. I thought, "How can I explain this? Is this anointing?" No, I had already operated in anointing. Prayer lines had fallen down and things like that. This was something different.

Can you believe I knew that little about the love of God? After that visitation, things picked up. I finally figured out what it was: the love of God under a certain kind of manifestation where it manifests tangibly and seems to appear as compassion.

Immediately after that, I could not have a meeting without one person starting to cry, then whole rows crying, then people all over the front crying. Even with a language barrier in Brazil, during that particular time, I tried to do a regular translated meeting and they started crying in the front.

I called a prayer line up, they fell over and started crying. I turned around to the translator, and he started crying and fell down. I lost him; I might as well go home.

Even though they did not understand me and I did not understand them, so much was received.

The Love Anointing Reaches People Religion Sends Home

I think I have seen that anointing before in isolated places, but when I asked Him, He quickly told me what it would do at the stage it was in. That tangible anointing born from the love of God manifests in compassion. I have it from a good source, and from the times it has shown up, that it heals the man who stays home, not just the nice front man they send to church.

These people made a tremendous dent in the world. They left cities, churches, and pastors behind. But somehow many of them were ridiculed and destroyed.

When I came past that place, after He had already been introducing me to the love of God, and I walked past it and it fell behind me and closed off, I got another understanding of the love of God. It has to do with His power and other things becoming resident deep in my spirit, where I understand the things that surface and begin to manifest in the future in what God has called to take place in His mind, which in our case is revival.

I was supposed to be dead, destroyed, or distracted into sensationalism. But when I stepped over on this side, something was different. Something happened to my understanding on the level of the love of God. Something happened deep in my understanding of His power, the manifestations of His power, and where impossible miracles come from.

Great preachers can name the list, but much of what has manifested has mostly been healing, not even teaching. How old does a child have to be before you can blame his parents? Old enough to be accountable? Are you going to blame the hospital because of the clinical atmosphere and unbelief? Are you going to blame the parents because they are unbelievers? Are you going to blame a three-month-old child and say he is not believing?

How long did it take the devil through the Dark Ages to beat this out of us? Thank God for the Azusa Street revivals and the awakening that began in receiving the Holy Ghost. The first arguments there were whether you can speak in tongues any time you want or whether He has to move on you to pray in tongues. Some believed He had to move on you, and others believed you could speak any time.

Just over a hundred years ago, things started emerging and leaning more toward the Spirit and power. Finally a group of us found out that the mind of God really can be prayed for us.

How long will it take us to rebuild to what the apostles walked in? Peter walked by, and every person along the way was healed. Not Jesus' meeting, Peter's meeting. Every single person was healed. I am sure at least one of them had your excuse.

How much did the devil beat out of us? Can we come back where the apostles were? If God is not withholding any of this from us, then obviously we can receive it, believe it, and act on it.

The Coming Outpouring Requires God to Speak Beyond Routine

When the avalanche fell behind me, it felt like a whole new realm in the love of God. I think I stumbled into what can bring the Scriptures to full power.

There was a prophecy on December 4:

Because of the abuse and misuse of the giftings of the Spirit, the enemy has been able to talk many, many moves back into a stagnant state. But there is much, much that I desire to say. There is much I desire to teach. There is much revelation of present time that I yearn to reveal. But most of the time I am cut off from speaking, for the enemy will take a routine from one step to the next to the next until My mind is programmed out of it. I hardly ever get to speak to the gathering of the people in My name.

You keep going in the direction that you are going and giving to Me what I need to do, and you will see that the outpouring coming in these last days will include massive moves of My power and understandings of the Holy Spirit.

That is what religion was designed to do: program His mind out of the meeting.

Choice Cost Heaven Everything and Makes Love Real Fellowship

The highest price heaven has ever sustained is your right to make choices. You are His sons and daughters. Pretty soon you will be neither one, because when we go to heaven, they neither marry nor are given in marriage. But we are His family. God is our Father.

We have no idea what it cost Him for us to have the freedom to make choices, have a heart, think things, and do things. It cost heaven everything.

He came from forever. You cannot fathom that. Before forever, He always was. Yet even being God, when you raise your hands and say, "I love You," He likes to know it was your choice.

Without that, "I love you, I love you," would be mechanical. Turn that thing off. What would you have? You could build yourself a husband out of springs, gears, and belts, but without choice, what do you have?

Forever, when we see Him, when we talk to Him, when we do things for Him, and when we love Him in fellowship, He will know that we are doing it because we love Him and that it was our choice.

I am glad, because I have gotten to walk into some of the substance He calls love, love and compassion. I know it is what will fill His promises from one end to the other with the manifestations of His power, glory, and everything He is in this revival.

If it is not the last days yet, we are going to have one anyway.

From Eden to the Cross, God Threaded Every Needle for Us

He started showing me this in the garden too, when Adam and Eve did what they did. God said, "Why? Did you not know I cannot lie? I told you that you would die. Why did you do it?"

Before He judged Adam and Eve, He looked four thousand years into the future:

| The seed of the woman shall bruise your head.

That seed, Christ, destroyed the power Satan had over death. The only way He could do that was by laying our sins on Jesus, as Him dying Himself. He prophesied the death of His own Son four thousand years in the future.

Then He could turn around, kill the animal, shed its blood, make Adam and Eve a kind of garment of righteousness, and clothe them. But before He did that, He could not do anything.

He loved me. I existed in Adam's DNA, and He loved me so much that He reached four thousand years into the future to the death of His Son so we could die with Him and rise with Him.

How much does He love you?

Whenever I go before Him to pray, I think of how many needles He threaded. "No, it cannot be an unclean animal. It has to be clean. No, you cannot go behind that curtain, only the high priest. No, you can only go once a year." Loads of commandments. They had to walk the line tediously, and God had to watch over this.

Why did He do it? To create a perfect shadow to bring Jesus into this planet. Why did He bring Him here? Because of you. One billion years from now, you are going to be somewhere. He did it for you.

When I go in to pray and say, "God, I am believing for this," I think about that first four thousand years He tediously went through to pay that price for me. And now, when I ask Him to do something He said He will do, He will not? He does not hear me? Come on.

Thousands of animals slain. The altar had to be just right. It had to be a certain kind of beast. And now we cannot get Him to do anything for us? He threaded needles for four thousand years, and you hope He hears you?

I think I said all of that to say this: I wondered what the last part would be. Would God just drop the power? What would be the deal?

To survive, spread, and grow strong with the love of God. The love of God. That is what is going to do it.